

Influence_Consensus_add_sic - In society, does addiction alone generally have a direct effect on the quality to Sickness/Disease Burden, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences.

Addiction alone has a clear, direct, and substantial negative effect on the global burden of sickness and disease. Substance use disorders, including alcohol and drug dependence, directly contribute to a significant portion of disability-adjusted life years (DALYs), with alcohol use disorders accounting for about 4% and drug use disorders about 1.7% of all global DALYs in 2016 (■ Degenhardt et al., 2018). Illicit drug dependence alone accounted for approximately 20.7 million DALYs globally in 2010, with opioid dependence being the largest contributor (■ Degenhardt et al., 2013). These disorders cause both years lived with disability (YLDs) and years of life lost (YLLs) due to premature mortality, reflecting their direct impact on health (■ Whiteford et al., 2013). Addiction also directly causes or exacerbates numerous medical conditions such as liver disease, cardiovascular problems, respiratory diseases, cancers, infectious diseases (e.g., HIV/AIDS), and mental health disorders (■ Charuni, 2024; ■ Eddie et al., 2019). Given this evidence, a reasonable normalized magnitude for addiction's direct influence on sickness/disease burden would be strongly negative, around -0.7 to -0.8 on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00 due to its large and well-documented health impacts worldwide (■ Degenhardt et al., 2018; ■ Degenhardt et al., 2013; ■ Whiteford et al., 2013; ■ Charuni, 2024).

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